



Running a Sales Team

Generating sales and dealing with customers are vital to most businesses and require expertise. If you do not have the skills to do this yourself, recruiting and motivating dedicated sales staff is the best route to success.

Finding the right salespeople

Whether you plan to hire a dedicated sales executive or team or to adopt selling responsibilities yourself, it is important to pinpoint the skills or qualities needed to best sell your product or service. For example, a salesperson adept at building trust and long-term

relationships will help a business reliant on a small number of repeat customers. While someone persuasive who can identify large numbers of potential customers will suit sales of one-off products or occasional services. If competition is fierce, an experienced salesperson



Steering the team

Sales staff should be encouraged and motivated to work to the best of their abilities—and pull together as a team. Set high, but achievable, sales goals that provide staff with the incentive to push themselves but in the knowledge that they have your full support. Be transparent about how the business is performing and all areas of its operation. Promote two-way feedback so that staff are clear on sales progress and you know their concerns and benefit from new ideas. Invest in sales training so staff develop new skills and feel valued.

Set expectations

- › **Ensure** that staff know what is expected in terms of sales targets and level of customer service.
- › **Define** a clear team structure and ways of working together.